Praneet Jayant Kala

Technical Project Manager • AI & Digital Transformation Delivery

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Professional Summary

Technical Project Manager with 6+ years of experience delivering enterprise IT and digital transformation initiatives across aerospace, defence, automotive and higher education sectors. Managed a multi-project portfolio including a flagship R800k enterprise deployment, leading cross-functional teams of up to 7 members while overseeing contracts, budgets and governance controls. Delivered measurable impact including a 5.7% productivity uplift in AI-enabled initiatives and 15–25% revenue growth within strategic accounts. Experienced across full project lifecycle including initiation, scope definition, WBS development, schedule planning, execution, risk control and structured delivery governance.

Experience

Co-founder & Director — Sep 2025 – Present
SoiQet

- Leading structured planning and phased delivery of an AI-enabled SaaS platform, defining scope, milestones and backlog prioritisation across product, data and integration workstreams.
- Translating business requirements into BRDs, user stories and execution plans, ensuring alignment between technical contributors and commercial objectives.
- Managing delivery risks, scope changes and dependency tracking through structured governance routines and sprint cadences, maintaining execution visibility and quality-controlled release cycles.
- Developed structured project artefacts including scope definition documents, high-level WBS and delivery roadmaps to guide phased execution across product and integration streams.

AI Innovation & Strategy Analyst (MSc Internship) — Mar 2024 – Jun 2024
Piab Group, Stockholm, Sweden

- Defined the roadmap for Piab's internal AI assistant platform, aligning Product, IT, Operations and Data teams on phased delivery, use-case prioritisation and workflow impact.
- Acted as Product Owner proxy, translating cross-functional requirements into structured user stories and ensuring traceability between technical components and business outcomes.
- Designed and delivered Power BI dashboards to leadership and functional teams, contributing to a measured 5.7% productivity uplift.
- Initiated governance discussions on AI usage, employee data practices and GDPR alignment, contributing to compliance-aware digital innovation.

Career break for full-time MSc studies in Innovation Management || Aug 2022 – Aug 2024

Team Lead / Digital Modernisation Manager — Jul 2021 – Jul 2022
Opti-Num Solutions, Johannesburg, South Africa

- Directed a multi-project enterprise IT portfolio with cumulative contract values exceeding R1.6m, including a flagship R800k deployment across aerospace, defence, automotive and higher education clients.
- Led 4 direct and 3 indirect team members across consulting, engineering and analytics functions, overseeing mobilisation, resource allocation and milestone tracking.
- Owned contract management, budget oversight and resource forecasting across concurrent engagements, contributing to 15–25% revenue growth within key strategic accounts.
- Built and maintained integrated delivery plans including WBS structures, Gantt schedules, dependency mapping and critical path tracking, ensuring alignment to scope, timelines and resource constraints.
- Defined and managed project scope, SOW alignment, budget baselines and change control processes, ensuring delivery within agreed financial and contractual parameters.
- Established and maintained RAID logs (risk, assumptions, issues, dependencies) and stakeholder communication plans to proactively manage delivery risks and execution transparency.

Senior Consultant — Digital Solutions & Modernisation Jul 2020 – Jun 2021
Opti-Num Solutions, Johannesburg, South Africa

- Supported structured delivery across full project lifecycle, contributing to scope definition, WBS development, effort estimation, schedule planning and execution tracking.
- Facilitated stakeholder workshops and Agile ceremonies to clarify objectives, manage dependencies and sequence deliverables across regulated environments.
- Produced and maintained project artefacts including status reports, RAID logs, stakeholder maps and communication updates to support governance and decision-making.
- Contributed to scope definition, effort estimation and mobilisation planning across aerospace, automotive and mining sectors.

Consultant — Innovation Enablement Feb 2018 – Jun 2020
Opti-Num Solutions, Johannesburg, South Africa

- Supported enterprise software deployment and adoption programmes, coordinating workshops, onboarding and training initiatives across multi-sector clients.
- Assisted with requirements documentation, KPI tracking and governance artefact maintenance aligned to defined delivery methodologies.

Application Engineer Jun 2016 – Jan 2018
Opti-Num Solutions, Johannesburg, South Africa

- Delivered technical implementation support including environment setup, software configuration and UAT assistance across enterprise deployment lifecycles.
- Provided documentation, compliance alignment and quality assurance support within regulated aerospace and engineering environments.
- Supported UAT planning, test coordination and deployment readiness activities, contributing to controlled project closure and transition phases.

Education

KTH Royal Institute of Technology 2022 – 2024
MSc in Innovation Management and Product Development
★ Swedish Institute Scholar — Competitive government-funded scholarship for leadership and innovation

University of the Witwatersrand 2010 – 2016
BSc in Mechanical Engineering

Publication: *Nonlinear control of quadrotor UAV using Takagi-Sugeno fuzzy logic technique* — IEEE Asian Control Conference 2015 • Jimoh O. Pedro; Praneet J. Kala

Core Skills & Competencies

- **Project Planning & Execution:** Scope definition, WBS development, Gantt scheduling, dependency mapping, critical path management and milestone tracking
- **Project Governance:** RAID log management (risk, assumptions, issues, dependencies), change control, status reporting and delivery governance frameworks
- **Commercial & Financial Management:** SOW alignment, budget ownership, cost tracking, resource forecasting and contract management
- **Stakeholder & Communication Management:** Stakeholder mapping, communication plans, executive reporting and cross-functional alignment
- **Delivery Methodologies:** Agile (Scrum ceremonies, sprint planning, backlog tracking) and Waterfall (phase-gated delivery, schedule baselining)
- **Tools & Platforms:** MS Project, JIRA, Excel dashboards, Power BI, enterprise IT delivery environments

Certifications

- Google Project Management Professional Certificate — Google (2025)
- Agentic AI for Leaders — Vanderbilt University (2025)
- Prompt Engineering — Vanderbilt University (2025)
- Agile Project Management & Agile Delivery — Udemy (2020)